

OpenClaw API-KEY Configuration

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1. Course Overview

This course will detail how to configure API-KEYs for AI models in OpenClaw, including the API-KEY application process, two configuration methods (CLI command configuration and configuration file modification), and how to verify if the configuration is successful. After completing this course, you will be able to successfully connect and use various AI model service providers.

1.1 Course Content

- Understand the types of model service providers supported by OpenClaw
- Master the API-KEY application method
- Learn how to view and verify the status of connected models

2. API-KEY Application

2.1 Recommended Model Service Providers

- Refer to the accompanying tutorial [2. AI Large Model Development] — [01-Register for model service provider account] for API-KEY application reference
- OpenClaw supports many model service providers, including:
 - **OpenAI** - GPT series (API + Codex)
 - **Anthropic** - Claude series (API + Claude Code)

- **Google** - Gemini series
- **Alibaba Cloud** - Qwen Cloud, Tongyi Qianwen
- **DeepSeek** - DeepSeek models
- **Zhipu AI** - GLM models
- **Moonshot** - Kimi + Kimi Coding
- **Ollama** - Local models (Cloud + Local)
- And many other service providers
- You can freely choose a model service provider based on your actual needs and local network policies, and register and apply for an API-KEY on the corresponding official website

3. Configuring OpenClaw API-KEY

3.1 Configuration Methods

OpenClaw provides two methods to configure API-KEY:

1. **CLI Command Configuration** (Suitable for beginners)
2. **Direct Configuration File Modification** (Suitable for developers)
 - Configuration file path: `$HOME/.openc1aw/openc1aw.json`

3.2 Quick Configuration

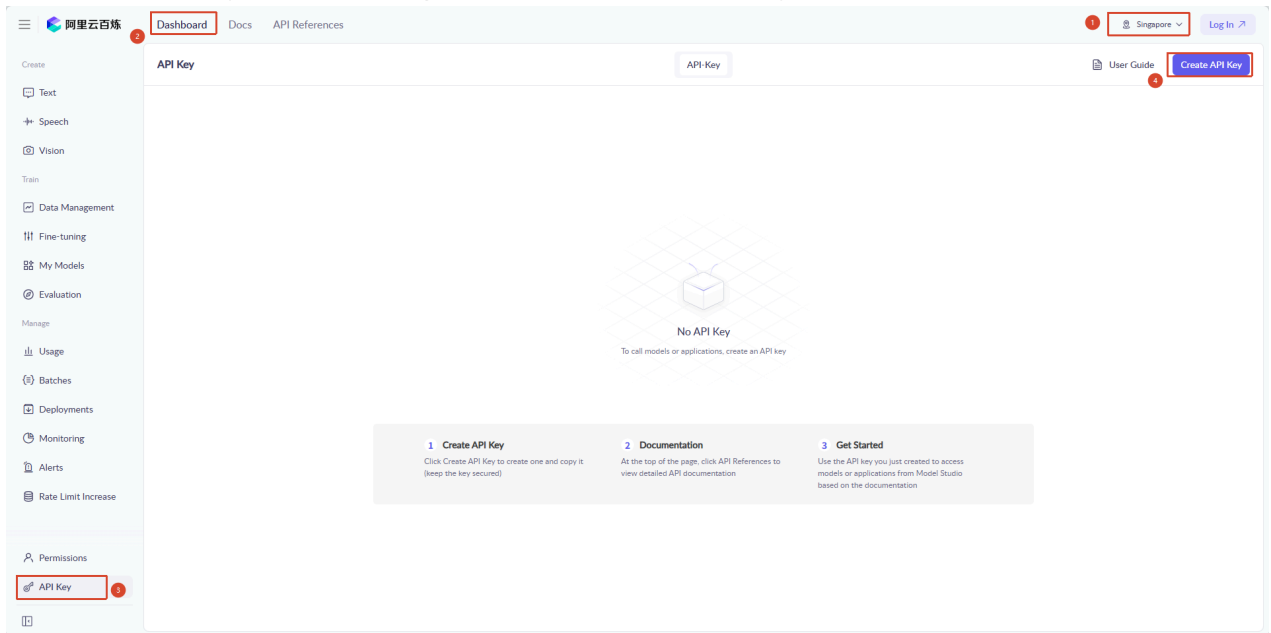
- Suitable for users who want to quickly get started and experience the service. You need to first register for an Alibaba Cloud Bailian large model account and create an API-KEY (refer to the accompanying tutorial [12.AI Model Development] — [01.Register a model service provider account])
- The factory preset configuration file has already configured the Bailian model parameters. Simply fill in the API-KEY to use it directly
- Open the OpenClaw configuration file:

```
nano $HOME/.openc1aw/openc1aw.json
```

3.2.1 Configure baseUrl

- **Users in mainland China do not need to modify this, skip this step.** Users in overseas regions should select the corresponding baseUrl based on their service region (go to the [Alibaba Cloud Bailian console](#) homepage, switch to the target region in the upper right corner of the page, such as **Singapore**,

then select **API Key** in the left navigation bar to create an API Key)

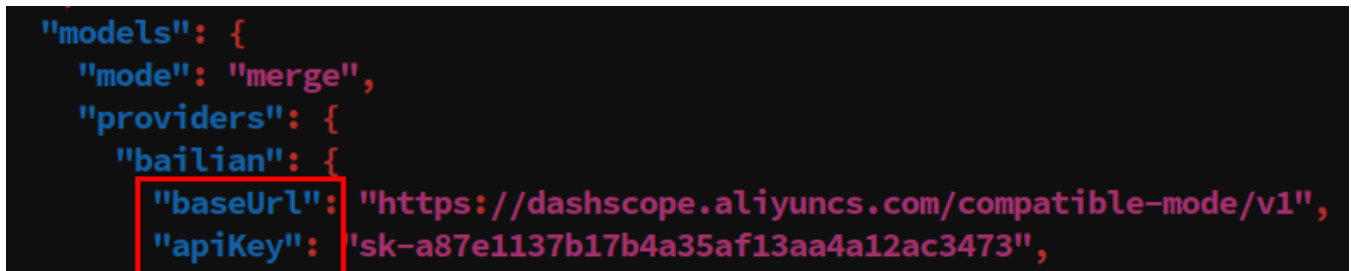


Base URL for API Key's Region:

Singapore: <https://dashscope-intl.aliyuncs.com/compatible-mode/v1>

US (Virginia): <https://dashscope-us.aliyuncs.com/compatible-mode/v1>

3.2.2 Fill in apiKey



- After filling in, press `Ctrl+X`, then press `Y` to confirm saving, and press Enter to exit

4. Viewing Connected Model Status

4.1 View Configured Model List

After configuration, you can use the following command to view the connected models:

```
openclaw models list
```

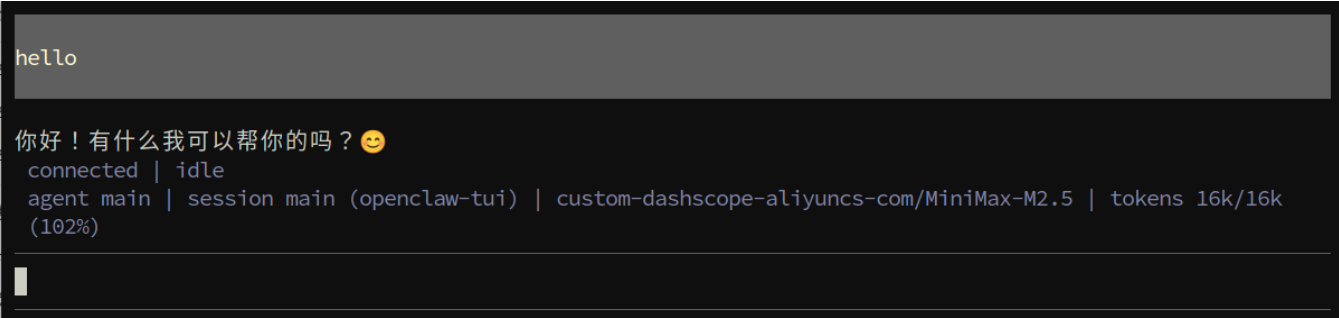
Model	Input	Ctx	Local	Auth	Tags
custom-dashscope-aliyuncs-com/MiniMax-M2.5	text	16k	no	yes	default,configured
bailian/qwen3.5-plus	text+image	977k	no	yes	configured
bailian/qwen3.6-plus	text+image	977k	no	yes	configured
bailian/qwen3-max-2026-01-23	text	977k	no	yes	configured
bailian/qwen3-coder-next	text	256k	no	yes	configured
bailian/qwen3-coder-plus	text	977k	no	yes	configured
bailian/MiniMax-M2.5	text	192k	no	yes	configured
bailian/glm-5	text	198k	no	yes	configured
bailian/glm-4.7	text	198k	no	yes	configured
bailian/kimi-k2.5	text+image	256k	no	yes	configured

4.2 Verify Configuration Success

1. Test Conversation

```
openclaw tui
```

Start the TUI interface and send a test message (such as "Hello") to confirm the model can respond normally.



5. Other Connection Methods (Advanced)

- If you have your own model provider or need to connect additional model providers later, refer to the following tutorials

5.1 CLI Command Configuration API-KEY (Suitable for Beginners)

1. Start Configuration Wizard

```
openclaw onboard
```

- Select **【Yes】** and press Enter

Recommended baseline:

- Pairing/allowlists + mention gating.
- Multi-user/shared inbox: split trust boundaries (separate gateway/credentials, ideally separate OS users/hosts).
- Sandbox + least-privilege tools.
- Shared inboxes: isolate DM sessions (`session.dmScope: per-channel-peer`) and keep tool access minimal.
- Keep secrets out of the agent's reachable filesystem.
- Use the strongest available model for any bot with tools or untrusted inboxes.

Run regularly:

```
openclaw security audit --deep
openclaw security audit --fix
```

Must read: <https://docs.openclaw.ai/gateway/security>

◆ I understand this is personal-by-default and shared/multi-user use requires lock-down. Continue?

● Yes / ○ No

- Select QuickStart for configuration mode and press Enter

◆ Setup mode

- QuickStart (Configure details later via openclaw configure.)
 - Manual

2. Select Model Service Provider

- Use the up and down arrow keys to select the service provider for which you have applied for an API-KEY, and press Enter to confirm. Here, we take the Alibaba Cloud Bailian model provider as an example. The configuration method for other model providers is the same.
- Here, select custom provider **【Custom Provider】**

◆ Model/auth provider

Search:

- Alibaba Model Studio
- Anthropic
- Arcee AI
- BytePlus
- Chutes
- Cloudflare AI Gateway
- Copilot
- Custom Provider (Any OpenAI or Anthropic compatible endpoint)

- Fill in the base_url of the model provider

```
◆ API Base URL
| https://dashscope.aliyuncs.com/compatible-mode/v1
```

3. Enter API-KEY

- After selecting a service provider, the system will prompt you to enter the corresponding API-KEY

```
◆ How do you want to provide this API key?
| ● Paste API key now (Stores the key directly in OpenCLaw config)
| ○ Use external secret provider
```

- Paste or enter your applied API-KEY and press Enter to confirm

```
◆ API Key (leave blank if not required)
| sk-a87e1137b17b4a35af13aa4a1xxxxxx
```

- Select **OpenAI-compatible** for the interface protocol

```
◆ Endpoint compatibility
| ● OpenAI-compatible (Uses /chat/completions)
| ○ Anthropic-compatible
| ○ Unknown (detect automatically)
```

4. Fill in the model name. Here, we take MiniMax as an example

```
◆ Model ID
| MiniMax-M2.5
```

- **Endpoint ID** is the model provider identifier and can be freely filled in

```
◆ Endpoint ID
| custom-dashscope.aliyuncs-com
```

- Leave **Model alias (optional)** blank

```
◆ Model alias (optional)
| e.g. local, ollama
```

5. Other Configuration

- For other configuration items, select skip as shown in the figure below. No configuration needed.

Select channel (QuickStart)

Search:

...

- Google Chat (Chat API)
- iMessage (imsg)
- IRC (Server + Nick)
- LINE (Messaging API)
- Matrix (plugin)
- Mattermost (plugin)
- Microsoft Teams (Teams SDK)
- Nextcloud Talk (self-hosted)
- Nostr (NIP-04 DMs)
- openclaw-weixin
- QQ Bot (Official API)
- Signal (signal-cli)
- Slack (Socket Mode)
- Synology Chat (Webhook)
- Telegram (Bot API)
- Tlon (Urbt)
- Twitch (Chat)
- WeCom (企业微信)
- WhatsApp (QR link)
- Zalo (Bot API)
- Zalo (Personal Account)
- Skip for now (You can add channels

◆ Search provider

Search:

- Brave Search
- Exa Search
- Firecrawl Search
- Gemini (Google Search)
- Grok (xAI)
- Kimi (Moonshot)
- Ollama Web Search
- Perplexity Search
- SearXNG Search
- Tavily Search
- Skip for now (Configure later with openclaw configure --section web)

```
◆ Skills status

Eligible: 16
Missing requirements: 38
Unsupported on this OS: 7
Blocked by allowlist: 0

◆ Configure skills now? (recommended)
○ Yes / ● No
```

- Press space to select **Skip for now** for Enable Hooks

```
Enable hooks?
■ Skip for now
□ 🚀 boot-md
□ 📎 bootstrap-extra-files
□ 📝 command-logger
□ 💾 session-memory
```

- Select Restart to restart the gateway and apply the configuration

```
Gateway service already installed
● Restart
○ Reinstall
○ Skip
```

5.2 Modify Configuration File (Recommended Method)

Configuration File Location

The configuration file is located at: `$HOME/.openclaw/openclaw.json`

Edit Configuration File

```
nano $HOME/.openclaw/openclaw.json
# Or use your favorite editor, such as vim, code, etc.
```

1. Add Model Provider Configuration

Add or modify the `models.providers` section in the configuration file:


```
{
  "models": {
    "providers": {
      "openai": {
        "apiKey": "OPENAI_API_KEY"
      },
      "anthropic": {
        "apiKey": "ANTHROPIC_API_KEY"
      },
      "google": {
        "apiKey": "GOOGLE_API_KEY"
      }
    }
  },
  "agents": {
    "defaults": {
      "model": {
        "primary": "openai/gpt-4"
      }
    }
  }
}
```

3. Configuration Notes

- `models.providers`: Configure API-KEYs for various model service providers
 - `openai.apikey`: OpenAI's API-KEY
 - `anthropic.apikey`: Anthropic's API-KEY
 - `google.apikey`: Google's API-KEY
- `agents.defaults.model.primary`: Set the default model to use
 - Format is `provider/model name`, such as `openai/gpt-4`, `anthropic/claude-3`, `google/gemini-pro`

4. Save and Exit

- Press `Ctrl+O` to save, `Ctrl+X` to exit (nano editor)

5. Factory Default Bailian Configuration (Can be directly modified or referenced)

```
"bailian": {
  "baseUrl": "https://dashscope.aliyuncs.com/compatible-mode/v1",
  "apiKey": "sk-a87e1137b17b4a35af13aaxxxxxxx",
  "api": "openai-completions",
  "models": [
    {
      "id": "qwen3.5-plus",
      "name": "qwen3.5-plus",
      "api": "openai-completions",
      "reasoning": false,
      "input": [
```

```
        "text",
        "image"
    ],
    "cost": {
        "input": 0,
        "output": 0,
        "cacheRead": 0,
        "cachewrite": 0
    },
    "contextwindow": 1000000,
    "maxTokens": 65536
},
{
    "id": "qwen3.6-plus",
    "name": "qwen3.6-plus",
    "api": "openai-completions",
    "reasoning": false,
    "input": [
        "text",
        "image"
    ],
    "cost": {
        "input": 0,
        "output": 0,
        "cacheRead": 0,
        "cachewrite": 0
    },
    "contextwindow": 1000000,
    "maxTokens": 65536
},
{
    "id": "qwen3-coder-next",
    "name": "qwen3-coder-next",
    "api": "openai-completions",
    "reasoning": false,
    "input": [
        "text"
    ],
    "cost": {
        "input": 0,
        "output": 0,
        "cacheRead": 0,
        "cachewrite": 0
    },
    "contextwindow": 262144,
    "maxTokens": 65536
},
{
    "id": "MiniMax-M2.5",
    "name": "MiniMax-M2.5",
    "api": "openai-completions",
    "reasoning": false,
    "input": [
```

```

      "text"
    ],
    "cost": {
      "input": 0,
      "output": 0,
      "cacheRead": 0,
      "cacheWrite": 0
    },
    "contextWindow": 196608,
    "maxTokens": 32768
  },
  {
    "id": "glm-5",
    "name": "glm-5",
    "api": "openai-completions",
    "reasoning": false,
    "input": [
      "text"
    ],
    "cost": {
      "input": 0,
      "output": 0,
      "cacheRead": 0,
      "cacheWrite": 0
    },
    "contextWindow": 202752,
    "maxTokens": 16384,
    "compat": {
      "thinkingFormat": "qwen"
    }
  },
  {
    "id": "glm-4.7",
    "name": "glm-4.7",
    "api": "openai-completions",
    "reasoning": false,
    "input": [
      "text"
    ],
    "cost": {
      "input": 0,
      "output": 0,
      "cacheRead": 0,
      "cacheWrite": 0
    },
    "contextWindow": 202752,
    "maxTokens": 16384,
    "compat": {
      "thinkingFormat": "qwen"
    }
  },
  {
    "id": "kimi-k2.5",

```

```
"name": "kimi-k2.5",
"api": "openai-completions",
"reasoning": false,
"input": [
  "text",
  "image"
],
"cost": {
  "input": 0,
  "output": 0,
  "cacheRead": 0,
  "cacheWrite": 0
},
"contextwindow": 262144,
"maxTokens": 32768,
"compat": {
  "thinkingFormat": "qwen"
}
}
]
```

6. Common Issues and Solutions

6.1 Invalid API-KEY or Error

Problem: Prompt showing API-KEY is invalid or authentication failed after configuration

Solution:

1. Confirm whether the API-KEY is correct (be careful not to have extra spaces)
2. Check if the API-KEY has expired or been disabled
3. Confirm if the account balance is sufficient (some service providers require prepaid balance)

6.2 Cannot Access Model Service

Problem: Cannot connect to model service even with correct configuration

Solution:

1. Check if the network connection is normal
2. Confirm if the network in your area can access the service provider (some services may require special network configuration)
3. Try switching to another model service provider for testing

7. Course Summary

Through this course, you have mastered:

- ✓ Types of model service providers supported by OpenClaw
- ✓ API-KEY application methods and precautions
- ✓ CLI command configuration method (suitable for beginners)
- ✓ Configuration file modification method (suitable for developers)
- ✓ Methods for viewing and verifying model configuration status
- ✓ Troubleshooting and solutions for common issues